



THE FIRST THERMAL HOTELS

The historic quarter of Escaldes-Engordany was the cradle of the first hotels, which saw in thermal water not only a source of health and well-being but also an opportunity to project the *parròquia* —and Andorra— towards a new economic model: tourism.

The first spa hotels included Hotel Pla, Muntanya, Paulet, Serra and Palacín, all of which offered therapeutic thermal baths in cast-iron tubs. They were located between Plaça Santa Anna and the Tosca Bridge, an area where the first shops of Escaldes also appeared, forming a new centre of activity.

A unique case is that of Hostal Valira, promoted by the monks of Montserrat, who settled in Escaldes in 1929, two years before the proclamation of the Second Spanish Republic. Faced with political instability in Spain, they founded the Cultural Andorrana SA company and promoted the construction of the Hostal. In order to use the thermal water, they signed an agreement with the Quart of Escaldes-Engordany (a local administrative subdivision) in 1934.